

Unit 4: Professional Etiquette: Essential Guidelines (Requirements, Dos& Don'ts):

Q1. Define etiquette. How is it different from manners and morals? (IMP)

Answer:

- **Etiquette** is a set of **accepted rules and norms** that guide how people behave in society or a professional setting. It shows respect, discipline, and professionalism.
- Example: Greeting seniors with “Good Morning,” using polite language in emails, and dressing properly for meetings.

Difference between Etiquette, Manners, and Morals

Aspect	Etiquette	Manners	Morals
Meaning	Rules of polite behavior in social/professional life	Way of behaving with others showing respect	Principles of right and wrong (ethics)
Focus	Formal conduct (dress code, greetings)	Personal habits (saying please, thank you)	Values and beliefs (honesty, integrity)
Example	Wearing formal dress in office	Helping someone carry books	Not cheating in exams

□ **Conclusion:** Etiquette is the **external code of conduct**, manners are the **daily behavior**, and morals are the **inner values** guiding human actions.

Q2. Explain the importance of professional etiquette. (IMP)

Answer: Professional etiquette is very important in today’s workplace because it creates a **positive impression** and helps build strong professional relationships.

Importance of Professional Etiquette:

1. **Creates First Impressions:**
 - The way you dress, talk, and greet people builds trust.
 - Example: Wearing formals in interviews gives confidence to the employer.
2. **Promotes Respect:**
 - Following etiquette shows respect for colleagues, seniors, and clients.
3. **Reduces Misunderstandings:**
 - Clear and polite communication avoids conflicts.
4. **Builds Professional Image:**
 - Good etiquette makes you appear disciplined and responsible.
5. **Improves Workplace Environment:**
 - Encourages teamwork, harmony, and cooperation among employees.
6. **Global Acceptance:**
 - In multinational companies, etiquette helps in cross-cultural communication.

□ **Conclusion:** Professional etiquette is **not just formality**; it is the key to career success, better teamwork, and smooth communication in any professional field.

Q3. Discuss the etiquette of small talks with examples.

Answer: Small talk means **short, casual conversations** on light topics that help people connect socially or professionally. It is an important part of professional etiquette.

Etiquette of Small Talks:

1. **Choose Safe Topics:**
 - Weather, travel, hobbies, sports, college life.
 - Example: “How was your weekend?” or “The weather is pleasant today.”
2. **Be a Good Listener:**
 - Show interest by nodding and asking follow-up questions.
3. **Be Polite and Positive:**
 - Avoid controversial topics like politics or religion.
4. **Respect Time:**
 - Keep it short, especially in professional meetings.
5. **Use Body Language:**
 - Smile, maintain eye contact, and show openness.

Examples of Good Small Talk:

- At an interview: “I heard your company recently won an award. Congratulations!”
- At a conference: “This session on Artificial Intelligence was very informative, don’t you think?”

□ **Conclusion:** Small talk is not meaningless — it builds comfort, trust, and stronger professional relationships.

Q4. What are the important workplace etiquettes to be followed by professionals? (IMP)

Answer: Workplace etiquette refers to the set of rules and polite behaviors expected in a professional environment. Following them helps maintain discipline, respect, and teamwork.

Important Workplace Etiquettes:

1. **Punctuality:**
 - Always reach office, meetings, or interviews on time.
 - Shows respect for others’ time.
2. **Dress Code:**
 - Wear neat and professional clothes.
 - Example: Formals in meetings, ID card in office.
3. **Polite Communication:**
 - Use respectful words like *please, sorry, thank you*.
 - Avoid harsh or rude tone.
4. **Respect Privacy:**
 - Knock before entering cabins, don’t peep into others’ screens.
5. **Teamwork:**
 - Cooperate with colleagues, share credit, avoid gossip.
6. **Email/Phone Etiquette:**
 - Use professional language in emails.
 - Keep calls short and polite.
7. **Work Discipline:**
 - Meet deadlines, avoid unnecessary leaves, stay focused.

□ **Conclusion:** Workplace etiquette is a must for career growth. It builds trust, reduces conflicts, and creates a positive environment.

Q5. Write short notes on Mobile Etiquette.

Answer: Mobile etiquette means using a mobile phone **responsibly and politely** without disturbing others in professional or social settings.

Mobile Etiquette Rules:

1. **Keep Phone Silent in Meetings:**
 - Switch to silent/vibrate mode in office meetings, classrooms, or conferences.
2. **Avoid Loud Conversations:**
 - Speak softly; don't disturb others with personal calls.
3. **Limit Personal Calls at Work:**
 - Use office time for work-related calls only.
4. **Do Not Use While Talking to People:**
 - It looks disrespectful if you check your phone when someone is speaking.
5. **Texting Etiquette:**
 - Use clear language, avoid abbreviations like "u, k, gr8" in professional texts.
6. **Emergency Only During Presentations:**
 - Avoid attending calls unless very urgent.

Examples:

- Wrong: Talking loudly on the phone in a meeting.
- Right: Sending a quick text like, *"I'm in a meeting, will call later."*

□ **Conclusion:** Following mobile etiquette shows **discipline, respect, and professionalism** in today's digital world.

Q6. Internet and Social Media Etiquette. (IMP)

Answer: Internet and social media etiquette refers to the **responsible and respectful use of online platforms** like email, WhatsApp, LinkedIn, Facebook, etc.

Rules of Internet & Social Media Etiquette:

1. **Use Professional Language:**
 - Avoid slang, abusive words, or all caps (it looks like shouting).
2. **Email Etiquette:**
 - Use subject lines properly, keep content short, and sign with name & designation.
3. **Privacy Respect:**
 - Do not share confidential office data or screenshots on social media.
4. **Be Authentic:**
 - Share correct and verified information, avoid fake news or rumors.
5. **Work-Life Balance:**
 - Avoid using social media during working hours unnecessarily.
6. **Cyber Safety:**
 - Use strong passwords, avoid offensive comments, and respect digital boundaries.

Example:

- Wrong: Posting negative remarks about boss/company on Twitter.
- Right: Sharing professional achievements on LinkedIn.

□ **Conclusion:** Following netiquette ensures **professional image, safety, and respect** in the digital workplace.

Q7. What are the Dos and Don'ts during a Foreign Business Trip? (IMP)

Answer: When traveling abroad for business, etiquette is very important as it reflects both **personal professionalism** and **company reputation**.

✓ **Dos:**

1. **Research the Country:**
 - Learn about their culture, language, and business style.
2. **Dress Appropriately:**
 - Follow local dress codes and business formal wear.
3. **Punctuality:**
 - Be on time for meetings and appointments.
4. **Polite Communication:**
 - Use simple, clear English; avoid jokes or slang.
5. **Exchange Business Cards Properly:**
 - With both hands (in countries like Japan).

✓ **Don'ts:**

1. **Don't Ignore Customs:**
 - Example: In Middle East, avoid using left hand for greetings.
2. **Don't Discuss Sensitive Topics:**
 - Avoid politics, religion, or personal criticism.
3. **Don't Assume Food Habits:**
 - Respect local dining etiquette (e.g., no beef in India, no pork in Muslim countries).
4. **Don't Violate Personal Space:**
 - Maintain proper body language and gestures.

□ **Conclusion:** Following proper etiquette during foreign business trips builds **trust, respect, and successful business relations**.

Q8. Explain Etiquette for Receiving a Foreign Counterpart. (IMP)

Answer: When a foreign counterpart visits, it is important to follow etiquette that shows **hospitality and cultural sensitivity**.

Etiquette Rules:

1. **Warm Welcome:**
 - Receive them at the airport or office reception. Greet respectfully (handshake, bow, or namaste depending on culture).
2. **Respect Cultural Differences:**
 - Learn about their customs. Example: In Japan, bowing is important; in Western countries, a handshake is normal.
3. **Professional Communication:**
 - Speak politely, avoid slang, and use simple language.

4. **Hospitality:**
 - Arrange local travel, meals (consider food restrictions), and accommodation.
5. **Gift Etiquette:**
 - Offer small, thoughtful gifts (like handicrafts) as a token of respect.
6. **Business Meetings:**
 - Be punctual, keep documents ready, and follow formal meeting etiquette.
7. **Non-verbal Respect:**
 - Maintain eye contact, avoid offensive gestures, and respect personal space.

Example:

- Wrong: Offering alcohol to a guest from a culture where it is forbidden.
- Right: Offering tea/coffee or a traditional gift.

□ **Conclusion:** Receiving a foreign counterpart with proper etiquette helps in **creating goodwill and building long-term professional relationships.**
